

6 Religion and society	6.1	The interpretation and application of ahimsa for a Buddhist in the modern world (4) a) The First Precept — to refrain from harming a living thing, the interpretation of ahimsa by Buddhists with specific examples of how this may be lived, such as vegetarianism, right livelihood and involvement in the armed forces. b) The role of other beliefs and considerations in the living of ahimsa, including differences in application and importance within different traditions, and in the example of the Buddha. Specific reference should be made to excerpts of the Pali Canon and the Lotus Sutra. With reference to the ideas of the 14th Dalai Lama and T Bartholomeusz.
	6.2	Issues in contemporary society a) The significance of teachings that underpin involvement and support in and for liberationist approaches to religion and society, religious freedom, religious tolerance, pluralism and interfaith dialogue for Buddhists in a multicultural society. b) The ways that Buddhists respond to diversity in different traditions of Buddhism. How different Buddhist traditions view other religious and non-religious world views and their truth claims. c) The benefits, extent of the involvement and potential barriers from a Buddhist context, including the difference in application and importance of interfaith dialogue in light of different traditions of Buddhism, including the different cultural and country contexts in which Buddhists are found. d) Buddhist teachings and responses to issues of science. How Buddhism has responded to these in the historical and contemporary world. With reference to the ideas of the 14th Dalai Lama and K Sri Dhammananda.

List of extracts for Paper 4A: Buddhism

Students are expected to study a range of texts that support and underpin their knowledge and understanding. The assessment will include two extended-response questions on an excerpt, sourced from this extracts list. The following texts are **not** exclusive to the topic areas under which they appear; students will need to be able to apply these texts across any suitable topic area. These are published in the *A Level Religious Studies Anthology: Paper 4A – Buddhism*, which can be downloaded from our website qualifications.pearson.com

Suggested translation of the Tipitaka is by Thanissaro Bhikkhu.

(1) Armstrong K – *Buddha, Chapter 3* Enlightenment, pp. 60–88 (Phoenix, 2002)
ISBN 9780753813409

(2) de Bary W T et al – *The Buddhist Tradition in India, China and Japan, Chapter 3* The Bodhisattva, pp. 81–109 (Knopf Doubleday Publishing Group, 2011) ISBN 9780307778796

(3) Rahula W – *Gems of Buddhist Wisdom, Chapter 27* Bodhisattva Ideal in Buddhism, pp. 461–471 (Kuala Lumpur, Malaysia: Buddhist Missionary Society, 1996)
ISBN 9789679920673

(4) www.accesstoinight.org/tipitaka/index.html (Samyutta Nikaya 42.3 *Yodhajiva Sutta: To Yodhajiva (The Warrior)*)